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Azhar Mahmood's stint as Pakistan's Test head coach has come to an end, with both parties opting to part ways by mutual consent. Appointed as acting head coach in June, Azhar's contract was originally set to run until March 2026. However, with no Tests scheduled until the away series against Bangladesh in March-April next year, the decision was taken to conclude the arrangement earlier than planned.

REUTERS



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Preparations for the ICC Under-19 Men's Cricket World Cup 2026 will step up as host Zimbabwe joins Afghanistan and Pakistan in a tri-nation series ahead of the tournament. With the World Cup scheduled from January 15 to February 6 across Zimbabwe and Namibia, the series offers vital match practice. The action begins on Christmas Day, December 25, with Zimbabwe taking on Afghanistan at the Harare Sports Club.

AP



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The International Cricket Council (ICC) and JioStar have reiterated that their India media-rights agreement remains valid, countering reports that the broadcaster plans to step away from the contract ahead of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026. "Preparations for these (T20 World Cup) events are progressing exactly as planned, and there is no impact on viewers, advertisers, or industry partners," the statement read.



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Bahrain pacer Ali Dawood etched his name into T20I history with a stunning spell of 7 for 19, the second-best figures ever recorded in men's T20 internationals. It marked only the second time a bowler has claimed seven wickets in the format. Dawood now sits just behind Malaysia's Syazrul Idrus, who holds the record with a remarkable 7 for 8 against China in an ICC Men's T20 World Cup Qualifier.

ICC